School Sync

Version 4 - complete setup guide, every single step

This app reads the school PDF that is sent to a WhatsApp group (or a community's Announcements) every night, lets a free AI read it, and adds a task to your TickTick list with the date and one checkbox for every subject. Everything is free. Follow the parts below in order, and do not skip any step.

You need: a Windows or Mac computer that is turned on at the time you choose, a phone with WhatsApp, a TickTick account, a Google account (for the free AI key), and about 30 minutes the first time.

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Important: this app uses an unofficial WhatsApp library. This is against WhatsApp's terms and there is a small risk to the account. Consider using a spare number. Never share your keys with anyone.

Part 1 - Install Node.js and Git (one time only)

1A - Node.js

1. Open your browser and go to **nodejs.org**.
2. Click the big green button that says **LTS**.
3. Open the file that downloads (double-click it).
4. Click **Next** on every screen, then **Install**, then **Finish**. Do not change any setting.

1B - Git

1. Go to **git-scm.com** and click **Download for Windows** (or the Mac download).
2. Open the file and click **Next** on every screen. Leave all settings as they are.
3. Click **Install**, wait, then click **Finish**.
4. **Restart your computer** (this makes sure both programs are found).

> **Why Git?** The app downloads the newest WhatsApp library from GitHub, and that needs Git.

Part 2 - Unzip the app and open it the first time

1. Find **School-Sync-v2.zip** (usually in your Downloads folder).
2. **Windows:** right-click it and choose **Extract All**, then click **Extract**. **Mac:** double-click it.
3. Open the new folder called **school-sync**. You should see files like **main.js**, **index.html**, **start.bat** and **start.command**.
4. **Windows:** double-click **start.bat**. A black window opens and says "Installing for the first time". Wait 3 to 5 minutes. Do not close it. When it finishes, the School Sync app opens by itself.
5. **Mac:** double-click **start.command**. If the Mac says it cannot be opened, right-click the file and choose **Open**, then **Open** again. If it says "permission denied", open the Terminal app, type **chmod +x** (with a space), drag **start.command** into the Terminal window, press Enter, then double-click it again.

> **Windows warning screen?** If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** and then **Run anyway**. The file only runs the commands written inside it.

The next times you open the app, it starts in a few seconds, because the installing is already done.

Part 3 - Get your free Gemini (AI) key

1. Go to **aistudio.google.com/apikey** and sign in with your Google account.
2. Click **Create API key**.
3. If it asks for a project, choose any project or let it create a new one.
4. Click the **copy** button next to the new key. Keep the page open, you will paste it in Part 5.

The key is like a password. Do not send it to anyone, and do not post it online.

Part 4 - Create your TickTick developer app

1. Go to **developer.ticktick.com** and sign in with your TickTick account.
2. Click **Manage Apps**, then **New App** (or **+**).
3. Type any name, for example **School Sync**.
4. Find the box called **OAuth redirect URL**. Type this **exactly**, with no spaces:

```
http://localhost:8765/callback
```

5. Click **Save**.
6. Open the app you just made. You will see a **Client ID** and a **Client Secret**. Keep this page open, you will copy both in Part 5.

If TickTick says "please enter the right URL", delete the box, type the address by hand (do not paste), and save again. If it still refuses, use **http://127.0.0.1:8765/callback** instead. Then open **main.js** (in the school-sync folder) with Notepad, press Ctrl+F, search for **REDIRECT**, and change the word **localhost** to **127.0.0.1** on that line. Save, and restart the app.

Part 5 - Set everything up inside the app

The app has three tabs at the bottom: **Home**, **Setup** and **Activity**. Open the **Setup** tab. Tap a row to open a window that slides up. Press **Done** to close it. Your changes are saved automatically.

5A - WhatsApp

1. Tap **WhatsApp**. A QR code appears after a few seconds (the first time it can take a minute).
2. On your phone open WhatsApp, go to **Settings** (or the three dots), then **Linked devices**, then **Link a device**, and scan the QR code.
3. Wait 1 to 2 minutes without clicking. The text changes to **Connected**. If the group list stays empty, press **Refresh groups**.
4. Tap the **School group** box. A list opens. Each community is a folder: click it to open it.
5. For a community, choose **Announcements** (that is where the school PDF is usually sent). If nothing is found there, try **Community main chat**. For a normal group, open **Other groups** and tap your group.
6. In **PDF name contains**, type part of the PDF's filename (for example **plan**). If you leave it empty, the app reads every PDF sent to that group.

5B - AI (Gemini)

1. Tap **AI (Gemini)**.
2. Paste your key from Part 3 into **API key**.
3. In **About the student**, write in plain words anything the AI must skip or keep. Example: "I am Muslim: skip Christian religion. I study German: skip French."
4. In **Subject order**, write your subjects in English, separated by commas, in the order you want them in TickTick. Example: **Arabic, English O.L, English H.L, Maths, Science, Social Studies, Religion, German, ICT, Art**. English O.L and English H.L are kept as two separate subjects.

5C - TickTick

1. Tap **TickTick**.
2. Paste the **Client ID** and the **Client Secret** from Part 4.
3. Press **Connect TickTick**. Your browser opens a TickTick page. Click **Allow**.
4. You see "Connected!". Close that browser tab and go back to the app. Click **Connect TickTick** only **once**.
5. Open the **TickTick list for the tasks** box and choose the list where you want the tasks (for example your School Books list).

5D - Schedule

1. Tap **Schedule**.
2. Choose the time you want the daily check. 23:00 means 11:00 PM.

Part 6 - Test it

1. Go to the **Home** tab. The WhatsApp and TickTick dots should be green.
2. Tap the big **liquid glass ball** in the middle of the Home tab. The screen edges glow and three steps light up: **Find PDF**, **AI reads**, **TickTick**. Reading can take from 10 seconds to 2 minutes.
3. Open TickTick. In your list you should see one task with the date, and one checkbox for each subject.
4. If the app says "No new PDF found", the last PDF is older than 26 hours. Ask someone to send a PDF to the group and try again.
5. To read the same PDF again (for example after changing a setting), press **Forget processed PDFs**, delete the old task in TickTick, and run again.

Add a PDF by hand (any PDF, any time)

1. On the **Home** tab, find the box called **Add a PDF by hand**.
2. **Drag a PDF** from a folder and drop it on the box, or anywhere in the app window. You can also **click the box** and choose the file from your computer. You can pick several PDFs at once.
3. The three steps light up, and the tasks are added to your TickTick list, the same way as the nightly check.
4. Only PDF files are accepted, up to 15 MB each. A copy is saved in **Documents / SchoolSync**.

Part 7 - Make it start by itself (the start.bat file)

The zip already contains a working **start.bat**. You have two choices. Choice A is the easiest.

Choice A (Windows) - use the start.bat that is already in the folder

1. Open the **school-sync** folder.
2. Right-click **start.bat** and choose **Create shortcut** (on Windows 11 choose **Show more options** first). A shortcut appears in the same folder.
3. Press the **Windows key + R** together. A small box opens.
4. Type **shell:startup** and press **Enter**. A folder opens (this is the Startup folder).
5. Drag the shortcut into that Startup folder.
6. Done. The app now opens every time you turn on your computer.

Choice B (Windows) - make your own start.bat from zero

1. Right-click an empty place on your Desktop and choose **New**, then **Text Document**.
2. Double-click it to open it in Notepad.
3. Copy these lines and paste them into Notepad:

```
@echo off
cd /d "%~dp0"
if not exist node_modules (
  call npm install
)
npm start
```

4. Click **File**, then **Save As**.
5. Under **Save as type**, choose **All files** (this is important, otherwise it saves as .txt).
6. In **File name** type **start.bat**. Choose the **school-sync** folder as the place to save, and click **Save**.
7. Delete the old "New Text Document" from the Desktop.
8. Continue with Choice A from step 2 to put it in the Startup folder.

> The line **cd /d "%~dp0"** means "go to the folder where this file is". That is why the file works even if you move or rename the folder. Keep start.bat inside the school-sync folder.

Mac - start with the computer

1. Make sure **start.command** opens correctly by double-clicking it (see Part 2).
2. Open **System Settings**, then **General**, then **Login Items**.
3. Click the **+** button, find the **school-sync** folder, choose **start.command**, and click **Open**.
4. Done. The app opens when you log in.

A small black window stays open behind the app on Windows. **Do not close it**, only minimize it, or the app closes too.

Part 8 - Keep it running every night

- **The computer must be on and awake** at your chosen time. If it is asleep, that night is missed.
- **Turn off sleep (Windows):** Settings, System, Power and sleep, then set **Sleep** to **Never** while plugged in.
- **Turn off sleep (Mac):** System Settings, Battery (or Energy), and stop it from sleeping while plugged in.
- **Closing the window only hides the app.** It keeps running in the tray (near the clock on Windows, the top bar on Mac). To really stop it, right-click the small green icon and choose **Quit**.
- Your phone must stay linked. If WhatsApp unlinks the computer, open the app and scan the new QR code.
- If the nightly run fails (for example because the AI is busy), the app tries again after 10 minutes, up to 4 times.
- The PDFs are saved in **Documents / SchoolSync** on your computer.
- In **Setup**, under **App**, there are switches for **Open at login**, **Open in full screen** and **Show intro**. The button in the top-right corner (or the F11 key) switches full screen on and off.
- Press and hold the glass pill in the bottom bar. It turns into a drop of liquid. Slide it left or right to switch between Home, Setup and Activity, then let go.

Part 9 - Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
"npm" or "node" is not recognized	Node.js is not installed, or you did not restart. Install it (Part 1A), restart the computer, and open start.bat again.
"git" is not recognized, or a Git error during install	Install Git (Part 1B), restart, and open start.bat again.
"Invalid Version" during install	Open the school-sync folder, delete the folder **node_modules** and the file **package-lock.json**, then double-click start.bat again.
TickTick page says "At least one redirect_uri must be registered"	In the TickTick developer page, set the OAuth redirect URL exactly to http://localhost:8765/callback and Save.
"Port 8765 busy"	The first Connect click is still waiting. Right-click the tray icon and Quit, open the app again, and click Connect TickTick only once.
Stuck on "Loading chats" or the group list is empty	Wait 2 minutes, then press Refresh groups. If it stays empty, Quit the app, delete the folder named wa inside %APPDATA%\school-sync, open the app and scan the QR code again.
QR code does not appear	Wait one minute. If still nothing, Quit the app completely and open it again.
"Gemini 503" or "busy"	Google's free server is busy. The app retries by itself. You can also wait a few minutes and press Run again.
"Gemini 400/403" or "No Gemini model available"	Check that the API key is pasted fully, with no spaces, in Setup, AI. Create a new key if needed.
"No new PDF found"	Only PDFs from the last 26 hours are checked. Make sure you chose the right group (for a community, Announcements) and that the PDF name box matches, or leave it empty.
Tasks added twice	Delete the extra task in TickTick. The app remembers every PDF it has read, unless you pressed Forget processed PDFs before running.
"TickTick login expired"	Open Setup, TickTick, and press Connect TickTick again.
Wrong subjects or dates	Edit About the student and Subject order, press Forget processed PDFs, delete the old task in TickTick, and run again.

Where is my information stored?

Your keys, WhatsApp login and settings are saved only on your own computer (in the app's user folder), never inside the school-sync folder. The PDF is sent to Google's Gemini so the AI can read it, so avoid using the app for PDFs with private information.